

Thready

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Category: Helix Development Threads-reading companion by Helix Development. Chartreuse-to-mint spiral brand on an AA-tuned slate; Space Grotesk display, Hanken Grotesk body; light + dark first-class.

Rev	Date	Author	Change
1	2026-07-22	swarm (design · opendesign)	Initial brand contract in the verified OpenDesign 9-section <code>DESIGN.md</code> schema; every value derived from <code>../design-system.md</code> / <code>../theming.md</code> / <code>../brand-assets.md</code> — nothing invented
2	2026-07-22	swarm (design · opendesign · verify)	Lens A/B compliance per the contributor authoring guide <code>[VERIFIED – open-design/docs/design-systems.md]</code> : added the Font labels for catalog extraction block (§3 — daemon parser regexes), an in-file <code>:root {}</code> + <code>[data-theme="dark"]</code> token block (§2), and real component CSS with a targeted <code>prefers-reduced-motion</code> gate (§4). Values unchanged

Machine-readable twin: `tokens.css` — the compiled CSS custom properties for this contract, following the OpenDesign token schema (`packages/contracts/src/design-systems/token-schema.ts`) with light + dark blocks. **Tooling status:** `TOOLING.md` .

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1. Visual Theme & Atmosphere

Thready is a **threads-reading companion**: calm, content-first, quietly organic. The brand mark is a **spiral — a thread unspooling into a helix coil** — read simultaneously as the Helix Development helix, a thread of posts, and an adaptive organic shell `[VERIFIED — ../brand-assets.md §2]`. The palette flows the same way the mark does: a chartreuse/lime green (`#B6E376`) sweeping into a soft mint/teal (`#ABDDC9`), both eyedrop-captured from `Logo.png` pixel evidence, never guessed `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §3.2]`.

The surfaces stay out of the way: brand-neutral **slate** neutrals (white / `#020817` night, `#475569` / `#94A3B8` muted) carried from the AA-verified `helix-green` theme of the shared `vasic-digital/design_system` — Thready is a **brand theme layered on that shared system, never a fork** `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §1]`. Light and dark are **both first-class**, with an explicit choice and a system default `[OPERATOR]`. One design system covers **every** surface — web, desktop, mobile, and the TUI `[OPERATOR — ../design-system.md §1]`.

Key characteristics:

- Spiral/thread brand mark, **letter-free by construction** (the OS prints the app title) `[OPERATOR — ../brand-assets.md §1]`
- Chartreuse→mint brand gradient, **decorative only** — text always uses the AA-pinned accent
- Slate neutrals shared with every Helix brand theme; brand color isolated so a white-label re-tints without touching structure `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §3]`
- Space Grotesk display / Hanken Grotesk body / JetBrains Mono code — all variable, self-hosted
- Light + dark palettes ship together; the user's mode choice selects which renders
- The locked footer: “Made with ♥ by Helix Development” — never removed, even white-labeled `[OPERATOR — ../theming.md §3]`

Brand identity — logo assets

All masters live beside this contract (relative refs from this folder) `[VERIFIED — files inspected]`:

Asset	File	Use
Launcher icon (master, neutral)	<code>../assets/launcher-icon.svg</code>	Letter-free double-helix + thread motif; source of every OS export
Launcher icon — light variant	<code>../assets/launcher-icon-light.svg</code>	Light home screens / white UIs; fill <code>#446E12</code> → <code>#B6E376</code>
Launcher icon — dark variant	<code>../assets/launcher-icon-dark.svg</code>	Dark home screens / <code>#020817</code> UIs; fill <code>#B6E376</code> → <code>#B7EBD6</code>
Launcher icon — monochrome	<code>../assets/launcher-icon-mono.svg</code>	Android themed/monochrome, iOS 18 tinted, notifications; <code>currentColor</code>
Brand mark (tight crop)	<code>../assets/logo-mark.svg</code>	Lockups, headers, avatars
Full logo lockup (mark + wordmark)	<code>../assets/logo-full.svg</code>	Headers / marketing only ; never inside the launcher icon
Footer slogan lockup	<code>../assets/footer-slogan.svg</code>	“Made with ♥ by Helix Development” attribution

Clear-space $\geq$ one outer ribbon width ($\approx \frac{1}{8}$ of the icon box); misuse rules (no letters, no recolor outside brand/mono, no skew, keep transparency) per `[VERIFIED — ../brand-assets.md §10]`.

Voice & tone

- **Warm, human, understated.** The one emotional flourish is the locked slogan “Made with love ♥ by Helix Development” (the heart carries the accessible name “love”) `[VERIFIED — ../brand-assets.md §8]`. Tagline: “read your threads, smarter” `[VERIFIED — ../brand-assets.md §8.1, login/splash]`.
- **Precise and honest.** Surfaces state what is real; unresolved items are marked, never papered over — mirroring the documentation “no bluff” bar `[VERIFIED — ../CONVENTIONS.md §7]`.
- **Localized by contract, not by habit.** Every UI string goes through the shipped `I18nService` keys (`footer.made` / `footer.by` / `a11y.love` / `a11y.language`); shipped locales en / ru / sr-Cyrl `[OPERATOR — ../design-system.md §4]`.
- Calm, reading-oriented microcopy; short sentences; no exclamation-mark enthusiasm `[DEFAULT — adjustable]`.

2. Color Palette & Roles

Every value below is carried verbatim from the Thready theme (`tokens/themes/thready.css` design, `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §3.2]`) which extends the measured, AA-verified `helix-green` theme. Nothing here is invented `[CONSTITUTION §11.4.6]`.

Brand (decorative only — never body text)

- **Brand base** (`#B6E376`) — chartreuse/lime; eyedrop **mean of 1,625,855 green-dominant logo pixels** `[VERIFIED]` . Only **1.47:1** on white — logo marks, gradients, one focal element.
- **Brand secondary — light** (`#ABDDC9`) — mint/teal; eyedrop mean of the `Logo.png` mint region (n = 618,886) `[VERIFIED]` .
- **Brand secondary — dark** (`#B7EBD6`) — the brighter mint **median**, used on dark surfaces so the mark holds `[VERIFIED]` .
- **Brand ink** (`#0A0F04`) — readable ink on a brand fill (13.15:1) `[VERIFIED]` .

Accent (interactive / text-safe — AA-pinned)

- **Accent — light** (`#446E12`) deep green = **6.03:1 on white** ; `--accent-on: #FFFFFF` .
- **Accent — dark** (`#B6E376`) the logo lime is the dark accent = **13.56:1 on #020817** ; `--accent-on: #0A0F04` . `[VERIFIED — measured, design_system THEMES.md]`

Surfaces & neutrals (brand-neutral slate, shared with all Helix themes)

Role	Light	Dark
Background <code>--bg</code>	<code>#FFFFFF</code>	<code>#020817</code>
Surface <code>--surface</code>	<code>#FFFFFF</code>	<code>#020817</code>
Warm/tertiary surface <code>--surface-warm</code>	<code>#F1F5F9</code>	<code>#1E293B</code>
Foreground <code>--fg</code>	<code>#020817</code>	<code>#F8FAFC</code>
Muted <code>--muted</code>	<code>#475569</code>	<code>#94A3B8</code>
Border <code>--border</code>	<code>#E2E8F0</code>	<code>#1E293B</code>
Strong border <code>--border-strong</code> (load-bearing boundaries ≥3:1)	<code>#64748B</code>	<code>#64748B</code>

Semantic (state, never decoration — never overridden by a brand)

Role	Light	Dark
Success	<code>#166534</code>	<code>#16A34A</code>
Warn	<code>#854D0E</code>	<code>#EAB308</code>
Danger	<code>#DC2626</code>	<code>#EF4444</code>

`--accent` (brand) and `--danger` (error) are **separate tokens by contract** — a brand color can never mask an error signal `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §6.2]` .

Heart glyph

`--ds-heart` defaults to `var(--accent)` (AA-legible in both modes) [\[VERIFIED precedent — ../brand-assets.md §8\]](#); classic love-red alternative is [\[OPEN: THREADY-DES-03\]](#).

White-label override points

Per-Account white-labeling swaps **only** these tokens, exactly as the three shipped themes prove works (`helix-green` / `vasic-red` / `helix-ota-blue`) [\[VERIFIED — ../theming.md §3\]](#):

Override point	Allowed	Guardrail
<code>--brand</code> , <code>--brand-2</code> (decorative)	▪	any hue; never used as text
<code>--accent</code> , <code>--accent-on</code> (light + dark pair)	▪ ×	server-validated WCAG AA ≥ 4.5:1 or rejected (422) [VERIFIED — ../theming.md §10]
Product logo (light + dark, transparent)	×	Asset-service refs
Slogan / tagline	×	free text
Structural tokens (type/space/radius/motion)		one system across all Accounts
Neutral surfaces + semantic tokens	(default)	AA-tuned; advanced override gated behind full AA re-validation
Helix Development attribution footer		always present

Dark-mode selection uses the three sanctioned mechanisms: `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark)` (system), `:root[data-theme="dark"]` (explicit), `.dark` (framework compat) [\[VERIFIED — ../theming.md §2\]](#). See `tokens.css` for the compiled blocks.

Color token blocks (light default + dark override)

The color-bearing tokens, in the `:root {}` + `[data-theme="dark"]` override pattern the authoring guide requires ([\[VERIFIED — open-design/docs/design-systems.md §3\]](#)); the full pasteable set — structural tokens and all three dark mechanisms — is `tokens.css`:

```

:root {
  --theme-id: "thready";
  --brand: #b6e376; --brand-2: #abddc9; --brand-ink: #0a0f04; /* decorative only */
  --bg: #ffffff; --surface: #ffffff; --surface-warm: #f1f5f9;
  --fg: #020817; --muted: #475569;
  --border: #e2e8f0; --border-strong: #64748b;
  --accent: #446e12; --accent-on: #ffffff; /* 6.03:1 on white [VERIFIED] */
  --success: #166534; --warn: #854d0e; --danger: #dc2626;
  --ds-heart: var(--accent);
  --fg-2: var(--fg); --meta: var(--muted); --border-soft: var(--border); /* B-slot aliases */
}

[data-theme="dark"] {
  --brand: #b6e376; --brand-2: #b7ebd6; --brand-ink: #0a0f04;
  --bg: #020817; --surface: #020817; --surface-warm: #1e293b;
  --fg: #f8fafc; --muted: #94a3b8;
  --border: #1e293b; --border-strong: #64748b;
  --accent: #b6e376; --accent-on: #0a0f04; /* logo lime IS the dark accent — 13.56:1
    [VERIFIED] */
  --success: #16a34a; --warn: #eab308; --danger: #ef4444;
  --ds-heart: var(--accent);
}

```

3. Typography Rules

Three shipped **variable** faces, self-hosted via `@fontsource` — no external CDN (offline/CSP posture)

`[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §4]`:

- **Display / headings:** "Space Grotesk Variable", ui-sans-serif, system-ui, sans-serif — weights 600–700, `h1–h3`, hero
- **Body / UI:** "Hanken Grotesk Variable", ui-sans-serif, system-ui, sans-serif — weights 400–500 (buttons 500, badges 600 `[VERIFIED — .ds-btn / .ds-badge]`)
- **Mono / code:** "JetBrains Mono", ui-monospace, "SF Mono", Menlo, monospace — code, post payloads, CLI transcripts, hashtags, IDs; **tabular figures** for aligned columns

Font labels for catalog extraction:

Display: “Space Grotesk Variable”, ui-sans-serif, system-ui, sans-serif
 Body: “Hanken Grotesk Variable”, ui-sans-serif, system-ui, sans-serif
 Mono: “JetBrains Mono”, ui-monospace, “SF Mono”, Menlo, monospace

Scale (px): 12 · 14 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 (`--text-xs` ... `--text-4xl`) **Line-height:** 1.5 body / 1.2 headings. **Letter-spacing:** -0.01em on display sizes. `[VERIFIED — core.css, ../design-system.md §3.1]`

Weight steps are subsets of one variable `wght` axis — no extra font downloads. Cyrillic coverage (ru, sr-Cyrl) is mandatory `[OPERATOR §12]`; subset verification is tracked as `[OPEN: THREADY-DES-04]`. Logical properties keep the type layer direction-agnostic.

4. Component Stylings

Principles first (non-negotiable `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §1/§6]`):

- **Consume, never fork** — every widget comes from the shared `.ds-*` set + Thready extensions; no bespoke one-off components, **TUI included**.
- **Brand is decorative, accent is interactive, semantic is state** — three disjoint color roles.
- **Focus visible everywhere** — `--focus-ring` (3px accent-tinted) on `:focus-visible`; shipped `.ds-btn`, `.ds-input`, toggle, and picker all implement it `[VERIFIED]`.
- Keyboard + screen-reader complete: correct accessible names (theme toggle `aria-pressed`, language picker is a native `<select>`) `[VERIFIED]`.

Stylings (token-bound; values from `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §5]`):

- **Buttons:** `--radius-sm` (8px), body face at weight 500, primary = `--accent` fill with `--accent-on` label; hover/active via `--accent-hover` / `--accent-active` (oklab mixes); focus via `--focus-ring`.
- **Cards:** `--surface` on `--border` 1px, `--radius-md` (12px); prefer `--elev-ring` over shadows in dark.
- **Inputs:** 1px `--border`, `--radius-sm`, accent-tinted focus ring; error state uses `--danger`, never the brand.
- **Chips / toggles / badges:** `--radius-pill`; badges weight 600 `[VERIFIED]`.
- **Sheets / large surfaces:** `--radius-lg` (16px).
- **Footer:** `.ds-footer` with the heart lockup — lucide SVG heart in `--ds-heart`, ordered fallbacks SVG →  → the word “love” `[VERIFIED — ../brand-assets.md §8]`.

Reference CSS (shipped button contract, verbatim)

The exact shipped `.ds-btn` — every color a token reference, focus via `--focus-ring`, reduced-motion gated on the component (never a global `*`) `[VERIFIED — design_system components.css, reproduced in ../component-library.md §3]`:


```

.ds-btn { display:inline-flex; align-items:center; gap:var(--space-2);
  font:500 var(--text-base)/1 var(--font-body); padding:var(--space-3) var(--space-5);
  border-radius:var(--radius-sm); border:1px solid transparent; cursor:pointer;
  transition: background-color var(--motion-fast) var(--ease-standard),
    color var(--motion-fast) var(--ease-standard),
    box-shadow var(--motion-fast) var(--ease-standard); }
.ds-btn:focus-visible { outline:none; box-shadow:var(--focus-ring); }
.ds-btn--primary { background:var(--accent); color:var(--accent-on); }
.ds-btn--primary:hover { background:var(--accent-hover); }
.ds-btn--primary:active { background:var(--accent-active); }
.ds-btn--secondary { background:transparent; color:var(--fg); border-color:var(--border-
  strong); }
.ds-btn--secondary:hover { background:var(--surface-warm); }
.ds-btn--ghost { background:transparent; color:var(--accent); }
.ds-btn--ghost:hover { background:color-mix(in oklab, var(--accent), transparent 90%); }
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) { .ds-btn { transition:none; } }

```

Badges tint by formula — `color-mix(in oklab, <semantic>, transparent 90%)` — so a theme or white-label swap re-tints every semantic badge with no new CSS `[VERIFIED — ../component-library.md §3]`.

Forms: validation + hints (mandated)

`[OPERATOR — "full forms validations, hints"]` Every field ships a **hint** line (`--muted`, `--text-sm`, wired via `aria-describedby`) and an inline **error** state (`--danger` text + border, `aria-invalid`, `aria-describedby` to the message). Errors are instructive, never bare — they carry the failing value and a concrete fix, the shape the branding editor's AA gate models (`422` returns the measured ratio + an AA-passing suggestion) `[VERIFIED — ../theming.md §7/$10]`. The full lifecycle (Loading → Skeleton ≥150ms → Content/Empty/Error → Validating → InvalidInline) is the single state machine in `../component-library.md §5b`.

5. Layout Principles

`[VERIFIED — core.css layout tokens, ../design-system.md §3.1/$5]`

- Content container **max 1200px** (`--container-max`), centered.
- Gutters: **24px** desktop / **16px** tablet / **12px** phone.
- Spacing on a **4px base**: 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 48 (`--space-1` ... `--space-12`).
- Section vertical rhythm: **80px** desktop / **48px** tablet / **32px** phone (`--section-y-*`).
- Whitespace is the primary separator; the reading pane is the hero of every screen `[DEFAULT — adjustable]`.

6. Depth & Elevation

Three levels only [VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §3.1/§5] :

Level	Token	Treatment	Use
Flat	<code>--elev-flat</code>	<code>none</code>	default
Ring	<code>--elev-ring</code>	<code>0 0 0 1px var(--border)</code>	hairline lift; preferred in dark (avoids muddy shadows)
Raised	<code>--elev-raised</code>	<code>0 2px 8px fg-mix at 8% (color-mix in oklab)</code>	dropdowns, modals, floating elements

No neumorphism, no glassmorphism [DEFAULT — adjustable, aligned with the shared system] .

Motion

- Two durations: `--motion-fast` **150ms** (hover/press, control state) and `--motion-base` **200ms** (enter/exit, disclosure), on `--ease-standard: cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)` [VERIFIED] .
- **All motion honors** `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` — the shipped components already gate transitions on it [VERIFIED — components.css] .
- Larger choreographed transitions (route changes, skeleton→content) extend these in `../prototypes.md` [DEFAULT — adjustable] .

7. Do's and Don'ts

Do

- Use `--accent` for every interactive/text emphasis; it is the only AA-pinned green.
- Keep the brand gradient (`#B6E376` → `#ABDDC9` / `#B7EBD6`) for marks, gradients, one focal element per screen.
- Ship light **and** dark for anything brand-colored; dark uses the brighter mint median.
- Route every string through i18n keys (en / ru / sr-Cyrl); test Cyrillic.
- Keep the Helix Development attribution footer on every surface — including white-labels.
- Use `--border-strong` for load-bearing boundaries (≥3:1 non-text contrast).
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` and reduced transparency.

Don't

- Never set body text in `--brand` or `--brand-2` (1.47:1 / ~2:1 on white) `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §6.2]`.
- Never use brand color for destructive UI — errors are always `--danger`.
- Never invent hex values outside this palette `[CONSTITUTION §11.4.6]` — if a request needs one, surface a warning and use the closest existing token.
- Never put letters inside the launcher icon `[OPERATOR — ../brand-assets.md §1]`.
- Never load fonts from an external CDN — all faces are self-hosted.
- Never re-bind structural tokens per theme or per Account — brand color only.

8. Responsive Behavior

Three tiers, bound to the section-rhythm and gutter tokens `[VERIFIED tiers — core.css]`; the pixel boundaries follow the OpenDesign starter defaults `[DEFAULT — adjustable]`:

- **Desktop ≥ 1024px:** 24px gutters, 80px section rhythm, full multi-column layout.
- **Tablet 640–1023px:** 16px gutters, 48px section rhythm, condensed nav.
- **Phone < 640px:** 12px gutters, 32px section rhythm, single column.

Touch targets ≥ 44×44px on touch surfaces `[DEFAULT — adjustable]`. Layout uses logical properties (`padding-inline` / `margin-inline`) so nothing assumes LTR `[VERIFIED — ../design-system.md §6.6]`.

Per-platform notes

The CSS custom properties are canonical; every non-web platform consumes a **generated** binding (OpenDesign `tokensToJson` → per-platform codegen), never a hand-kept copy `[VERIFIED mechanism — ../design-system.md §7]`. Honest status per the gap register:

Platform	Mechanism	Status	Notes
Web — Angular 19 (product) / 22 (marketing)	<code>@vasic-digital/design-system</code> <code>.ds-*</code> + <code>ThemeService</code> / <code>I18nService</code> adapters	PRODUCTION-usable (web foundation) <code>[GAP: 8.1]</code>	Primary surface; Thready adds one theme file + <code>DS_CONFIG</code> (<code>storagePrefix: 'thready'</code> , <code>defaultTheme: 'system'</code>)
Desktop — Tauri 2	Wraps the Angular web UI	Inherits web	OS-chrome overrides only; no separate token work
Mobile — KMP / Compose (Android, iOS/SwiftUI host)	<code>UI-Components-KMP</code> + token-bridge codegen (Compose <code>Color</code> / <code>Dp</code>)	SCAFFOLD , no CI/publish <code>[GAP: 8.4]</code>	Fetches effective branding at login; do not claim it works today
Mobile alt — ArkTS (HarmonyOS) / Qt (Aurora)	native clients via <code>helix_shims</code> ; <code>helix_design</code> tokens	SCAFFOLD <code>[GAP: 8.2/8.3/8.5]</code>	Only HarmonyOS/Aurora path; layered icon JSON ready
TUI — Lipgloss (Bubble Tea)	Generated Go palette from the same tokens	Pattern verified in-house <code>[VERIFIED]</code>	Dark palette default: <code>Accent #B6E376</code> , <code>Fg #F8FAFC</code> , <code>Muted #94A3B8</code> , <code>Border #1E293B</code> , <code>Danger #EF4444</code> , <code>Success #16A34A</code> ; heart =  glyph

9. Agent Prompt Guide

Quick color reference

- Accent (light): “deep green (#446E12)” on white — the only text-safe green in light mode
- Accent (dark): “logo lime (#B6E376)” on night (#020817)
- Brand gradient: “chartreuse (#B6E376) → mint (#ABDDC9 light / #B7EBD6 dark)” — decorative only
- Page background: “#FFFFFF light / night (#020817) dark”
- Text: “ink (#020817) light / snow (#F8FAFC) dark”; muted “slate (#475569 / #94A3B8)”
- Border: “#E2E8F0 light / #1E293B dark”; strong boundary “#64748B”
- Danger stays “#DC2626 / #EF4444” — never the brand green family

Example component prompts

- “Create a primary button: deep-green (#446E12) fill, white label, 8px radius, Hanken Grotesk 500, 150ms hover to the oklab-darkened accent, 3px accent-tinted focus ring.”
- “Design a post card on `--surface` with a 1px #E2E8F0 border, 12px radius, title in Space Grotesk 600 at 20px, body in Hanken Grotesk at 16px/1.5, metadata in JetBrains Mono with tabular figures.”
- “Build the dark variant: night (#020817) surface, snow (#F8FAFC) text, lime (#B6E376) accent with dark ink (#0A0F04) on fills, ring elevation instead of shadows.”
- “Add the footer: ‘Made with ♥ by Helix Development’, heart in `var(--ds-heart)`, SVG → ♥ → ‘love’ fallbacks, localized via `footer.made / footer.by`.”

Iteration guide

1. Paste the `tokens.css` `:root` + dark blocks into the artifact’s first `<style>` and reference everything via `var(--...)` — never restate hex inline.
2. One brand-gradient focal element per screen, at most.
3. Always author both modes; check the accent flips (#446E12 ↔ #B6E376) and `--accent-on` flips (#FFFFFF ↔ #0A0F04).
4. Errors and destructive actions: `--danger` only.
5. If a value is missing, do **not** invent it — flag it and use the nearest token `[CONSTITUTION §11.4.6]`.

Made with love ♥ by Helix Development.